We Built Something Together

Civic Skill: Cooperation | EYLF: EYLF Outcome 2 (Community) & Outcome 1 (Identity) | Duration: 20–30 minutes | Age: 4–6 years

LEARNING INTENTION

Children will celebrate and consolidate the four civic skills developed across the program, experiencing themselves as part of a community that has built something real, and deciding together what comes next.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can name one thing I've learned about empathy, difference, long-term thinking, and cooperation.
- I can say one thing I'm proud of that I made or did with my class.
- I can describe one thing I want to keep doing after the program ends.

MATERIALS

- All documentation from the program: mural, plants, consequence chains, comfort kits, repair corner, class meeting records
- The sealed letters from Lesson 13 (if written, open them now if the timing is right)
- A 'What We Built' display assembled before the session
- A simple 'going forward' card for each child
- Celebration food if appropriate (decided democratically in the previous class meeting)

ACTIVITY STEPS

1. ARRIVAL: GALLERY WALK (5 min): Children walk through the 'What We Built' display. Educator narrates: 'We made all of this. Not in one day. Over a long time, with care.'

2. OPEN THE LETTERS (5 min — if using): Read letters from Lesson 13. Compare predictions with reality. 'Was future-you right? What changed? What stayed the same?'

3. FOUR SKILLS REFLECTION (8 min): Move through each skill, briefly. For each one: 'What's one moment in this program when you used this? What was hard about it? What surprised you?' Take 1–2 responses for each skill — keep it moving.

4. GOING FORWARD CARD (5 min): Each child draws or dictates: 'One thing I will keep doing after today is ___.' Read each one aloud. These are the children's own civic commitments.

5. CLASS MEETING DECISION (5 min): 'We have one more decision to make together. Something about our room that we've built — what do we want to do with it? How do we want to keep it going?' Make one small real decision together.

6. CLOSING CEREMONY (2 min): Gather in a circle. 'Every time you notice how someone is feeling, you use empathy. Every time you're curious instead of judging, you use difference. Every time you think about what comes next, you use long-term thinking. Every time you choose together over alone, you use cooperation. Those are yours now. No one can take them back.'

EXTENSIONS

- Send the 'going forward' cards home with a family letter explaining the program and inviting families to ask their child about it
- Begin planning: where does the program go next? A new cohort? A community action project? A showcase for families?
- Submit the class mural to a local council, library, or community space as a permanent installation

ASSESSMENT

- The 'going forward' card is the final portfolio artefact document and keep
- Individual observation over the final week: which skills appear spontaneously in the child's play and relationships?
- Final learning story: synthesise observations from across the program into a narrative of each child's civic development

EDUCATOR REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- What changed in your room over the course of this program — not just in the children, but in you?
- Which of the four skills do you find hardest to model yourself? What does that reveal?
- What would it mean to make this not a program that ends, but a permanent feature of how this room works?

EYLF LINKS

This lesson directly supports EYLF Outcome 2 (Community) & Outcome 1 (Identity). Educators should record observations using anecdotal notes, photographs, or learning stories focused on children's language, body responses, and social interactions during the session.